

EXPLOITED VULNERABILITY ADVISORY: CVE-2026-20079

Summary

CVE-2026-20079 in Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center (FMC) and Security Cloud Control (SCC) Firewall Management is being actively exploited in the wild. A vulnerability in the web interface of Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center (FMC) Software could allow an unauthenticated, remote attacker to bypass authentication and execute script files on an affected device to obtain root access to the underlying operating system.

This vulnerability is due to an improper system process that is created at boot time. An attacker could exploit this vulnerability by sending crafted HTTP requests to an affected device. A successful exploit could allow the attacker to execute a variety of scripts and commands that allow root access to the device. CISA requires federal remediation by 2026-09-12; under the CRA, exploitation of an affected product must be reported within 24 hours.

What we know

- **CVE:** CVE-2026-20079
- **Affected:** Cisco Secure Firewall Management Center (FMC) and Security Cloud Control (SCC) Firewall Management
- **Exploitation:** Actively exploited, added to CISA KEV on 2026-09-09
- **Severity:** CVSS 10.0 Critical, Network-exploitable, no privileges required, no user interaction (CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:C/C:H/I:H/A:H)
- **Exploitation likelihood (EPSS):** 36%
- **Weakness:** CWE-288

Recommended action

Patch CVE-2026-20079 by 2026-09-12. If you cannot patch immediately, restrict network access to the affected service now (segment it, put it behind a VPN, or take it offline) until you can patch. If you ship an affected product, be ready to file the CRA 24-hour report the moment you find it exploited.

Sources: CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities, NIST NVD. Public data; an advisory of active exploitation, not an incident report. Verify applicability to your estate before acting.